

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 151

By Crowe

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Felix Guignard of
Johnson City.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Felix Guignard; and

WHEREAS, a musician, pianist, accordionist, and composer of music, Felix Guignard was an exemplary gentleman and consummate professional who worked assiduously to improve the quality of life for his fellow citizens in numerous capacities; and

WHEREAS, Felix "Fe'Fe" Guignard was born on November 3, 1927, to Francois and Christiane Saladin Guignard in Port-au-Prince, Haiti, where his father played the piano professionally and had his own band; and

WHEREAS, although Francois Guignard did not want his son to become a musician, Christiane Saladin Guignard urged her husband to teach their son to play the piano, and young Felix Guignard fell in love with music and quickly learned all the basic techniques of music; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Guignard started his career as a musician playing in Haiti for sixty cents per night; at the age of fifteen, he played for the president of Haiti and was also a part of his personal band and later played for then Vice President Richard Nixon on his visit to Haiti; and

WHEREAS, performing around the world, Felix Guignard was a pianist at a few of the finest hotels in Atlanta, Georgia, including the Omni International and Marriott Marquis. He also performed in St. Croix in the U.S. Virgin Islands and Guadeloupe in Martinique West Indies; and

WHEREAS, an exceptional linguist, Mr. Guignard could speak a number of different languages, including French, Creole, Spanish, and English, which helped his career in the Islands; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Guignard later moved to St. Croix in the U.S. Virgin Islands, where he played piano professionally and raised his children. In 1951, he played at the Cherry Blossom Festival under the famous musician and conductor Toscanini with many other musicians from around the world; and

WHEREAS, the next phase of his life saw him move to the United States, where he started his musical career in Atlanta, Georgia, and met his long-life partner, Carol Fair, who was a flight attendant for Piedmont, British Airways, and US Airways; and

WHEREAS, after spending thirty years with his musical career in Atlanta, Mr. Guignard retired and moved with Ms. Fair to Johnson City at Fair Oaks; he shared his musical talents with Johnson City through performances at the Johnson City Country Club, local places in Johnson City, and at Fair Oaks for parties hosted by Ms. Fair; and

WHEREAS, during some of his travels, he had the opportunity to play Cole Porter's piano at the Waldorf Astoria Hotel in New York City; in Las Vegas, he played George Gershwin's piano and the famous mirrored piano of Liberace; and

WHEREAS, a recording artist, his albums include *Poor People of Haiti*, *A Paris*, and his best and final album, *Aubade*, which he produced in 2006. Felix Guignard was one of the last Old World musicians of Haiti; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Guignard was also deeply devoted to his family, and he always endeavored to remain true to family values of the highest order; and

WHEREAS, Felix Guignard is survived by his life partner, Carol Fair; his children, Pastor Winnie Guignard (Pastor Yves) Pierre, Felix Guignard, Jr., Ronald Guignard, Nadege G. (Ishmael) Claxton, Wagner (Rose) Guignard, and Gerald D. Guignard; his sisters, Laure Guignard Pierre, Annie Marie Guignard Thomas, and Adeline Guignard Baptist; his brother, Edner Guignard; and a host of grandchildren, great-grandchildren, and extended family members; and

WHEREAS, Felix Guignard leaves behind an indelible legacy of integrity and probity in public life, compassion and loyalty in private life, and diligence and dedication in all his chosen endeavors; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Felix Guignard, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Guignard.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.